

Windows Photo Viewer was a handy and straightforward utility in Windows 7, so it's a bit perplexing that Microsoft decided to gradually phase it out in favour of the volatile "Photos" app in following Windows versions.

Microsoft has made it difficult to reinstall the Photo Viewer by eliminating the "exe" file entirely. However, with a small workaround, you can make it your default photo viewing app once more. Here's how to do it.

If you upgraded to Windows 10 from Windows 7 or 8, good news: you should still have registry entries for Windows Photo Viewer on your PC, and setting Photo Viewer as the default shouldn't be a problem.

One way is to locate a JPEG, PNG, or other image file that you want to associate with Photo Viewer, right-click it, then pick "Open with" and "Windows Photo Viewer" from the drop-down menu. If it isn't there, go to the "Open with" menu and select "Choose another app," then scroll down to the bottom, click "More apps," scroll down to the bottom again, click "Look for another app on this PC," then go to "C:\Program Files\WindowsPhoto Viewer" and select the Windows Photo Viewer executable.

If you can't find the executable, it's either because your Windows version didn't have it to begin with or because Microsoft removed it in a recent update. Photo Viewer is still on your computer, but as a "dll" file rather than an executable. We'll need to generate a new registry file to get it back.

Click below to see the code, then copy and paste it into a blank Notepad file.

Windows Registry Editor Version 5.00

```
[HKEY_CLASSES_ROOTApplicationsphotoviewer.dll]
```

```
[HKEY_CLASSES_ROOTApplicationsphotoviewer.dllshell]
```

```
[HKEY_CLASSES_ROOTApplicationsphotoviewer.dllshellopen]
"MuiVerb"="@photoviewer.dll,-3043"
```

```
[HKEY_CLASSES_ROOTApplicationsphotoviewer.dllshello-
pencommand]
```

```
@=hex(2):25,00,53,00,79,00,73,00,74,00,65,00,6d,00,52,
00,6f,00,6f,00,74,00,25,
00,5c,00,53,00,79,00,73,00,74,00,65,00,6d,00,33,00,32,
00,5c,00,72,00,75,00,
6e,00,64,00,6c,00,6c,00,33,00,32,0
```